

Skills Summary

Ten-Frames: Seeing Numbers to Ten

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Five and Some More

Rule: A full top row is 5. When the top row is full, do not recount it — just count on through the bottom row: “six, seven, ...”

Example: A ten-frame has a full top row and 2 dots in the bottom row. How many in all?

Step 1. The full top row is five without counting, so start at five and count on the bottom dots.

Step 2. “Six, seven” — $5 + 2 = 7$.

Try it: A ten-frame has a full top row and 3 dots in the bottom row. How many in all?

8 :check:

Skill 2 — Almost Ten

Rule: A full frame is 10. When a frame is nearly full, count the *empty boxes* instead — each empty box means one less than ten.

Example: A ten-frame has just 1 empty box. How many dots?

Step 1. Counting nine dots is slow — count the one empty box and take it away from ten.

Step 2. $10 - 1 = 9$ — nine at a glance.

Try it: A ten-frame has 3 empty boxes. How many dots?

7 :check:

(!) Watch out: Empty boxes count *down* from ten, dots in the bottom row count *up* from five. Pick the one with less to count!

Skill 3 — Building a Number on the Frame

Rule: To show a number, **fill the top row first** (that is 5), then put the rest in the bottom row. Numbers bigger than five always look like “a full row and some more.”

Example: Show 7 on a ten-frame. How many dots go in each row?

Step 1. Fill the top row with five first, then figure out how many are still needed to reach seven.

Step 2. Count on from five: “six, seven” — $7 - 5 = 2$ dots go in the bottom row.

Try it: Show 9 on a ten-frame. After filling the top row, how many dots go in the bottom row?

4 :check: